

FAMILY STUDIES

OVERVIEW

In the social sciences and humanities curriculum, family studies is a multidisciplinary subject area that encompasses four areas: fashion and housing; food and nutrition; general family studies; and raising and caring for children. The topics covered in these areas include, among others: textile production; the functions and design of clothing; the fashion industry; issues related to housing; interior design; the role of nutrition in health; the relationship between food and culture; human and family interactions and development; life management skills; various types of relationships; and considerations related to raising and caring for children.

In family studies courses, students learn about laws and policies that affect individuals and families in Canada and around the world. They also become familiar with the theoretical perspectives and practical research that underpin our understandings of individual and family development. Family studies courses also integrate theory and practical skills. Many expectations can be achieved through practical experiences both in the classroom and in co-op placements, some of which may be affiliated with Specialist High Skills Majors programs.

All courses in family studies encourage students to develop critical and creative thinking skills. Students are given opportunities to deepen their understanding of relevant issues and to develop practical skills, including research and inquiry skills. Students are encouraged to explore a range of perspectives and approaches and to develop the habits of mind that enhance individual, family, and community well-being and contribute to lifelong learning.

FOOD AND NUTRITION

Food and Nutrition, Grade 9 or 10

Open

HFN10/20

This course focuses on guidelines for making nutritious food choices. Students will investigate factors that influence food choices, including beliefs, attitudes, current trends, traditional eating patterns, food-marketing strategies, and individual needs. Students will also explore the environmental impact of a variety of food choices at the local and global level. The course provides students with opportunities to develop food-preparation skills and introduces them to the use of social science research methods in the area of food and nutrition.

Prerequisite: None

A. RESEARCH AND INQUIRY SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore topics related to food and nutrition, and formulate questions to guide their research;
- A2. Investigating:** create research plans, and locate and select information relevant to their chosen topics, using appropriate social science research and inquiry methods;
- A3. Processing Information:** assess, record, analyse, and synthesize information gathered through research and inquiry;
- A4. Communicating and Reflecting:** communicate the results of their research and inquiry clearly and effectively, and reflect on and evaluate their research, inquiry, and communication skills.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1.1** explore a variety of topics related to food and nutrition (*e.g., Canadian food regulations, food safety, school food regulations*) to identify topics for research and inquiry
- A1.2** identify key concepts (*e.g., through discussion, brainstorming, use of visual organizers*) related to their selected topics
- A1.3** formulate effective questions to guide their research and inquiry

Teacher prompt: “If you were researching Aboriginal recipes, what might be the advantage of investigating foods based on ingredients that are available in an urban setting (*e.g., sweet potatoes*) as well as foods based on ingredients that are more readily available in rural settings (*e.g., venison*)?”

A2. Investigating

Throughout this course, students will:

- A2.1** create appropriate research plans to investigate their selected topics (*e.g., outline purpose and method; identify sources of information; develop research tools such as surveys or questionnaires*), ensuring that their plans follow guidelines for ethical research

Teacher prompt: “Many people believe that teenagers prefer fried fast food for lunch to healthier alternatives such as salads, soups, and sandwiches. How could you design a study to investigate whether this is true among the students at your school? What would be the advantages and disadvantages of using a survey in your research? What would be the advantages and disadvantages of doing an observational study?”

- A2.2** locate and select information relevant to their investigations from a variety of primary sources (*e.g., informal interviews and surveys, personal food journals, data sets from Statistics Canada*) and/or secondary sources (*e.g., textbooks, advertisements, brochures, newspaper and magazine articles, online encyclopedias*)

Teacher prompt: “What is the difference between primary and secondary sources in the social sciences? Why would you consult only secondary sources for some research questions but use both secondary and primary sources for other research questions?”

- A2.3** based on preliminary research, for each investigation formulate a hypothesis, thesis statement, or research question, and use it to focus their research

A3. Processing Information

Throughout this course, students will:

A3.1 assess various aspects of information gathered from primary and secondary sources (*e.g., accuracy, relevance, reliability, inherent values and bias, voice*)

Teacher prompts: “What strategies can you use to determine the relevance of the information you have gathered?” “If two information sources contradict each other, how might you determine which is more reliable?” “How can you determine whether an information source is biased? If an information source is biased, might it still be useful for your research?”

A3.2 record and organize information and key ideas using a variety of formats (*e.g., notes, graphic organizers, audio/visual/digital records*)

A3.3 analyse and interpret research information (*e.g., compare results of surveys and interviews; determine whether common themes arise in different sources*)

A3.4 demonstrate academic honesty by documenting the sources of all information generated through research

A3.5 synthesize findings and formulate conclusions (*e.g., weigh and connect information to determine the answer to their research question*)

A4. Communicating and Reflecting

Throughout this course, students will:

A4.1 use an appropriate format (*e.g., oral presentation, brochure, flyer, poster, report, multimedia presentation, web page*) to communicate the results of their research and inquiry effectively for a specific purpose and audience

A4.2 use terms relating to food and nutrition correctly (*e.g., nutrients, nutrient-dense foods, snacking, body image, food security*)

A4.3 clearly communicate the results of their inquiries (*e.g., write clearly, organize ideas logically, use language conventions properly*), and follow APA conventions for acknowledging sources (*e.g., generate a reference list in APA style*)

A4.4 demonstrate an understanding of the general research process by reflecting on and evaluating their own research, inquiry, and communication skills

Teacher prompts: “How might the research methods you used have affected the results you obtained?” “What steps might you take to enhance your research/inquiry skills?”

B. NUTRITION AND HEALTH

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. Canada's Food Guide:** demonstrate an understanding of the nutritional and health recommendations in Canada's Food Guide;
- B2. Eating Patterns:** demonstrate an understanding of eating patterns that contribute to optimal physical health;
- B3. Body Image and Attitudes about Food:** demonstrate an understanding of factors that contribute to a positive body image and healthy attitudes about food.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. Canada's Food Guide

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** describe the key messages and recommendations in Canada's Food Guide (*e.g., food illustrations included, foods emphasized, statements about exercise*)

- B1.2** describe diverse foods within each of the food groups as described in Canada's Food Guide

Teacher prompt: "What are some non-dairy sources of calcium as shown in the Milk and Alternatives group in Canada's Food Guide?"

- B1.3** describe appropriate serving sizes as defined in Canada's Food Guide

Teacher prompt: "What common everyday objects can be used to represent appropriate serving sizes as defined by Canada's Food Guide (*e.g., a deck of cards is the same size as a serving of meat*)?"

- B1.4** identify key nutrients, their sources and functions, and the food groups in which they can be found (*e.g., carbohydrates in the Grain Products group, protein in the Meat and Alternatives and Milk and Alternatives groups*)

- B1.5** describe people's nutritional needs at different stages in the lifespan, as outlined in Canada's Food Guide

Teacher prompt: "Which nutrients are especially important for very young children? For seniors?"

- B1.6** interpret the information on the labels of a variety of packaged foods (*e.g., Nutrition Facts table, ingredient list, nutrient claims*) to determine their nutritional content

Teacher prompt: "How would you use the Nutrition Facts tables to compare two similar products to determine which would be the most nutritious? What additional information would you want to know?"

- B1.7** plan nutritionally adequate meals using the guidelines in Canada's Food Guide

Teacher prompt: "How would the foods/meals appropriate for a young teenager differ from those appropriate for the teenager's pre-school-age sister or brother?"

B2. Eating Patterns

By the end of this course, students will:

- B2.1** explain the differences between nutrient-dense foods and empty-calorie foods and their effects on health

Teacher prompts: "What is the most nutritious snack to have before doing a physical activity? Why?" "An apple and a chocolate bar have the same number of calories. Why would an apple be a better snack choice?"

- B2.2** explain why it is important to eat a nutritious breakfast (*e.g., to improve mood, energy level, school performance, workplace productivity*)

Teacher prompts: "What criteria would you use to determine whether a breakfast is nutritionally

balanced?” “How does eating breakfast affect your energy and performance levels?”

B2.3 describe the role of healthy snacking in achieving and maintaining optimal health (*e.g., meeting nutrient needs, satisfying hunger between meals, providing energy*)

B2.4 evaluate existing programs and policies that encourage eating for optimal health (*e.g., breakfast programs, school food and beverage policies, trans-fat regulations*)

Teacher prompt: “What criteria should be used to evaluate the health benefits of a breakfast program, or of ministry policies setting nutrition standards for schools?”

B2.5 assess their own eating patterns and create a personal eating plan to achieve optimal physical health

Teacher prompt: “How could you change your eating patterns in order to eat a healthier diet?”

B2.6 plan and prepare a snack and/or breakfast food that is nutrient dense

B3. Body Image and Attitudes about Food

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 describe positive and negative influences on body image (*e.g., cultural, social, media, peer group, family*)

B3.2 describe and evaluate some current theories about the relationship between body type/shape and health (*e.g., different shapes can be healthy; waist circumference is a predictor of diabetes and stroke risk*)

B3.3 outline strategies for achieving and maintaining a positive body image and healthy attitudes about food (*e.g., critically examining media messages, educating oneself about trends, using positive self-talk, setting priorities, participating in varied activities, talking with others*)

Teacher prompt: “What supports do teens need to help them develop a positive relationship with food?”

C. FOOD CHOICES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Food Needs:** demonstrate an understanding of factors affecting people's food needs and of ways of meeting those needs;
- C2. Influences on Food Choices:** demonstrate an understanding of various factors that influence food choices;
- C3. Media, Advertising, and Food:** demonstrate an understanding of how media and advertising messages affect food choices.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Food Needs

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** describe factors that affect people's food needs (*e.g., food preferences, dietary and health needs, busy schedules, major life changes*)
Teacher prompt: "How would you plan meals to meet special food needs in your household?"
- C1.2** describe effective strategies to use in selecting, preparing, and serving food to meet a variety of food needs (*e.g., creating a budget, estimating per-serving costs, using coupons, planning menus and meals, developing appropriate food-preparation skills and techniques, preparing foods in advance*)
- C1.3** describe ways in which household members can contribute to the provision of food both inside and outside the home (*e.g., planning meals, shopping for food, preparing food, cleaning up*)
- C1.4** plan and prepare a food item or items to address specific food needs (*e.g., the need for a low-sodium diet, a low-cholesterol diet, a healthy diet for a person with a hectic schedule*)

C2. Influences on Food Choices

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** identify different factors that influence people's food choices (*e.g., nutritional, cultural, emotional, environmental, religious, social, ethical, economic*)

Teacher prompts: "Why do some people choose to be vegetarian?" "How can you modify your food choices to reduce your impact on the environment?" "Why might some people choose to eat organic foods while others choose to eat local foods as a way of reducing their impact on the environment?" "What foods do you eat that are specific to your family, culture, and/or religion?"

- C2.2** explain how personal, family, and community resources (*e.g., money, time, knowledge, ability, equipment, availability of foods*) influence personal food choices

- C2.3** explain how childhood eating habits can influence lifelong eating patterns

Teacher prompts: "How do the eating patterns you had as a child influence your current eating patterns?" "How do you see your eating patterns changing in the future?" "What foods and food traditions would you want to pass on to your own children? What foods and food traditions would you not want to pass on to your own children?"

- C2.4** analyse how social situations influence food choices

Teacher prompts: "How does being with friends influence your food choices?" "How do different social situations influence your food choices?" "How are your food choices influenced by the foods and beverages that are available in your school?"

C3. Media, Advertising, and Food

By the end of this course, students will:

- C3.1** describe how various media (*e.g., flyers, magazines, billboards, radio, television, the Internet*) are used to promote the consumption of different types of foods (*e.g., fresh produce, health foods, fast foods, energy drinks, restaurant meals*)
- C3.2** analyse techniques that are commonly used to promote food products (*e.g., celebrity endorsements, selective limiting of information, scare tactics, brand recognition, product placement, end-of-aisle displays*)

Teacher prompts: “How effective is product placement as a food-marketing strategy?”

“When fast-food restaurants and pop companies sponsor large sporting events, what messages are conveyed?” “How are healthy food options promoted at school?”

- C3.3** analyse their personal food choices to determine the extent to which they are influenced by media and advertising/promotional techniques

D. LOCAL AND GLOBAL FOODS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Availability of Food:** demonstrate an understanding of where various foods are produced;
- D2. Food and Environmental Responsibility:** demonstrate an understanding of how various food-purchasing choices and food-preparation practices affect the environment;
- D3. Food Security:** demonstrate an understanding of issues related to food security.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Availability of Food

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1.1** identify the different types of foods produced in Canada (*e.g., fish, meat and poultry, dairy products, grains, vegetables, fruit*)

- D1.2** explain how various factors affect the availability of local foods (*e.g., proximity to agricultural land, length of growing season, presence of infrastructure such as greenhouses or fish farms, weather, soil conditions*)

Teacher prompts: “What foods are produced in your community only in spring, summer, and/or fall? What foods are produced year round?” “What makes the Niagara region so well suited to growing peaches and other soft fruits?”

- D1.3** explain why certain foods are imported from other countries (*e.g., tropical fruits, nuts, ocean fish, coffee, tea, chocolate*)

Teacher prompts: “How much do our eating patterns depend on imported foods?” “Why are some foods imported to Ontario (*e.g., garlic from China or apples from New Zealand*) when they can be grown locally?” “How can a common recipe be changed to use more local foods?”

- D1.4** identify factors that influence where people choose to shop for food (*e.g., local grocery store, bulk-food store, big-box store, farmers’ market, roadside stand, pick-your-own farm*)

Teacher prompt: “Why might some people choose to buy their food at a farmers’ market rather than a big-box store?”

- D1.5** plan and prepare a food item or items and identify the source of most of the ingredients

D2. Food and Environmental Responsibility

By the end of this course, students will:

- D2.1** assess their personal and family food-purchasing and food-preparation practices to determine their effect on the environment (*e.g., local foods require less fossil fuel for transportation; homemade foods require less packaging*)

Teacher prompts: “Which would reduce your carbon footprint more – organic produce or local produce?” “How can individuals and families ensure that the fish and seafood they consume are grown and harvested in environmentally responsible ways?”

- D2.2** assess programs and practices that reduce the impact of food production and consumption on the environment (*e.g., recycling programs, organic farming, food co-ops, community gardens*)

Teacher prompt: “What food-related programs could your school and community support to help the environment?”

- D2.3** outline environmentally responsible food-related strategies that can be used in the home (*e.g., using cooking techniques that require less energy, cultivating home vegetable gardens, packing lunches in reusable containers, using reusable shopping bags, buying in bulk, recycling, vermi-composting*)

D3. Food Security

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 identify the components of food security
(e.g., availability, accessibility, adequacy, acceptability, sustainability)

D3.2 explain why some people in Canada cannot achieve food security (e.g., lack of access to safe drinking water in smaller communities or communities with deteriorating infrastructure; low income; lack of knowledge about nutrition or food preparation; lack of resources or lack of access to resources; poor growing conditions or low crop yields as a result of soil depletion or natural disasters)

D3.3 identify some misconceptions and myths about hunger (e.g., *it does not happen in Canada; there is not enough food in the world*), and explain the reasons for them

Teacher prompt: “What are the realities behind the myths about hunger? Why do the myths persist?”

D3.4 identify local programs to increase food security (e.g., education programs, food banks, community kitchens, community gardens), and assess their effectiveness

Teacher prompts: “What are some local organizations that work to promote food security?”
“What facilities exist in your school and community to promote food security? How effective are they? How could they be improved?”

E. FOOD-PREPARATION SKILLS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1. Kitchen Safety:** demonstrate an understanding of practices that ensure or enhance kitchen safety;
- E2. Food Safety:** demonstrate an understanding of practices that ensure or enhance food safety;
- E3. Food Preparation:** demonstrate skills needed in food preparation;
- E4. Kitchen Literacy and Numeracy:** demonstrate the literacy and numeracy skills required in food preparation.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

E1. Kitchen Safety

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1.1** describe common accidents that can occur in the kitchen (*e.g., cuts, burns, fires, falls, poisoning, electric shocks*)
- E1.2** demonstrate an understanding of safe practices within the food-preparation area (*e.g., safely handle hot foods; prevent spatters, scalds, and cuts; wipe up spills immediately*)
- E1.3** demonstrate an understanding of appropriate emergency responses to common accidents associated with food preparation (*e.g., cuts, burns, scalds, fires*)

E2. Food Safety

By the end of this course, students will:

- E2.1** describe the causes and symptoms of food-borne illnesses (*e.g., E. Coli poisoning, botulism poisoning, Clostridium perfringens poisoning, salmonellosis, listeriosis*) and techniques for preventing them
- E2.2** use appropriate personal hygiene practices to prevent contamination of food (*e.g., wash hands frequently; cover a cough or sneeze in their sleeve; use gloves to cover cuts or wounds; tie hair back*)

- E2.3** demonstrate the use of safe food-handling practices required to prevent cross-contamination by pathogens, parasites, and allergens in the food-preparation area (*e.g., wash fresh produce; sanitize cutting boards after contact with meat products; sanitize implements that come into contact with allergens when preparing food for or with people with known allergies; sanitize work surfaces; replace and/or sanitize sponges and cloths frequently; use proper clean-up procedures*)

- E2.4** follow appropriate protocols to ensure food safety (*e.g., cook foods to recommended temperatures; keep hot foods hot and cold foods cold; store food appropriately; wipe tops of cans before opening; check "best-before" dates; demonstrate awareness of common allergenic ingredients*)

E3. Food Preparation

By the end of this course, students will:

- E3.1** identify and select appropriate kitchen tools, equipment, and ingredients for use in food preparation
- E3.2** demonstrate the ability to safely use, maintain, clean, and store tools and equipment used in food preparation
- E3.3** demonstrate the ability to measure quantities accurately (*e.g., use different strategies for measuring wet and dry ingredients; level off excess amounts; measure liquids at eye level*)

- E3.4** demonstrate the correct use of food-preparation techniques (*e.g., stirring, beating, whipping, chopping, broiling, frying*)
- E3.5** demonstrate the ability to manage time effectively in food preparation
- E3.6** plan, prepare, and serve a food item or items according to set criteria

E4. Kitchen Literacy and Numeracy

By the end of this course, students will:

- E4.1** identify various sources of recipes (*e.g., cookbooks, the Internet, newspapers, magazines, food packages, appliance manuals, recommendations from family or friends*)
- E4.2** describe useful information found in cookbooks and other sources of recipes (*e.g., conversion charts, nutrition information, cooking techniques, food-related terminology, storage tips*)
- E4.3** compare various recipe formats (*e.g., narrative, standard, active*)
- E4.4** demonstrate the ability to follow a variety of recipe formats
- E4.5** apply mathematical skills correctly in food preparation tasks (*e.g., convert between metric and imperial measures; calculate yield changes*)